

means that running a number of Windows applications on Wine at the same time is not very advisable. However, the combination of Wine and Linux is still faster than Windows XP in many cases, and some of the older games that do not run on XP or Vista run perfectly fine on Wine.

Wine comes as a standard with many distros, but if it does not, go to package manager or software manager and search for Wine. The installation varies from a 6-MB to a 15-MB download depending on the dependencies and the version of the software. The latest beta version of Wine supports more software, but is not as stable. Deb packages for download are available at <http://www.winehq.org/download/deb> and RPM packages are available at <http://tinyurl.com/5pg2w>. Ubuntu, Mint or Debian-based users will require the deb package, and Mandriva, SUSE or RedHat users would require the RPM package. When Wine is installed, it adds itself as a separate category in the applications list. Notepad is one of the few programs given as a default along with Wine.

Wine uses a directory inside the Linux file system as the C drive of a Windows system. Normally, this address is `/home/user/.wine/dosdevices/c:`. All the games that you want to install, should be installed in this location. Installing a game is relatively easy, as the installation will have windows similar to those in the Windows operating system, irrespective of how your Linux distro is themed. You can also copy and paste game folders from another location into this address. Games that run when the files are copy-pasted run particularly well with Wine.

Once the game is pasted, you will have to check for a few things. To see if Open GL is working properly on your system, go to the terminal, and type:

```
$ glxinfo | grep direct
```

If you see:

```
direct rendering: Yes
```

then Open GL is working perfectly fine. If the system does not display the above message, install Open GL again, or update your distribution. Next, go to Menu>Wine>Configure Wine>Drives and make sure that all the CD/DVD drives that you have is detected. This is essential for games that require the CD/DVD to be in the drive to work properly. Once you put in a CD or DVD into the disk drive, there will be a prompt asking you whether or not to autorun. On Linux, the safest thing to do is to click on No or Cancel depending on your distro.